

Online Complaint Summary

2/18/26 10:14 PM

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Board:	Medical Board of California
License Type:	Physician's and Surgeon's
Complaint Number:	8002026127102
Incident Date:	11/09/2025

Description:

Nature of Complaint: Gross Negligence, Extreme Departure from the Standard of Care, Unprofessional Conduct (Solicitation of Illegal Acts), and Failure to Establish/Provide Care under Dangerous Circumstances.

Detailed Description:

I attended a scheduled intake evaluation with Dr. Paula Bailey-Walton, a board-certified Addiction Medicine specialist. I was specifically referred to this evaluation by a New Directions counselor who assured me Dr. Bailey-Walton was equipped to medically manage a taper off of Xanax (a short-acting benzodiazepine).

During the clinical intake, rather than establishing a safe treatment plan, Dr. Bailey-Walton exhibited a severe and dangerous departure from the standard of care:

Solicitation of Illegal Black-Market Activity: Instead of initiating a standard medical taper (such as a transition to a longer-acting benzodiazepine), Dr. Bailey-Walton explicitly asked if I could "find any longer-acting benzos off of the street" where I was getting the Xanax. When I stated no, she provided no medical oversight, effectively instructing a prospective patient to use the illicit drug market to self-manage a highly dangerous withdrawal syndrome.

Inappropriate Prescribing Practices: When asked how she treats dependency, she stated she only uses Naltrexone for alcohol and Suboxone for opioids. Despite knowing I was already established on Suboxone, and despite Suboxone having absolutely no pharmacological efficacy for benzodiazepine withdrawal, she ended the encounter by asking if I was "ok on the Suboxone" and "did I need any help with that," attempting to push an unsolicited controlled substance rather than treating the acute condition I presented for.

Inappropriate Delegation / Refusal to Treat: Despite operating as a specialist and conducting a formal intake for a patient actively seeking help, Dr. Bailey-Walton refused to provide direct medical management. Even after I informed her that I had already attempted to utilize county resources, she initiated a call to the Los Angeles County substance abuse helpline (SASH) during our session. Turfing an acute,

high-risk patient sitting in her office to a generalized county triage line—after her own facility’s staff assured me she would provide medical management—constitutes an egregious failure to treat.

Dr. Bailey-Walton’s instruction to procure controlled substances from street dealers is a gross ethical violation. Her actions put my immediate physical safety at extreme risk. I request the Board investigate her intake protocols, her prescribing practices, and her solicitation of illegal patient activity.

Incident Address 1

Business Name/Facility Name:	New Directions
Address Line 1:	1331 West Avenue J
City:	Lancaster
State:	California
Zip:	93534
Hospital:	No
Home:	No
Other:	Yes
If you responded 'Yes' to the previous question, please provide a description of the location of the incident.	Outpatient Drug and Alcohol Rehabilitation Center

Additional Complaint Information 1

Have you filed a complaint with any other government agency regarding this incident?	No
Does this complaint concern a child custody issue?	No
Was the person named in this complaint appointed by the court to prepare a custody recommendation to the court?	No
If children are involved in this case, do you have joint legal custody of the child/children involved in this case?	No
Have you tried to resolve or mediate this complaint?	No
Reason for treatment:	Benzodiazepine (Xanax) Taper
Patient Name:	Nicolas Hernandez
Date of Birth:	■■■■■■ (mm/dd/yyyy)
Relationship to the patient:	Self

Substandard Care (e.g. misdiagnosis, negligent treatment, delay in treatment, etc.)	Yes
Prescribing Issues (e.g. excessive/under prescribing, Internet)	Yes
Unlicensed Provider or Aiding/Abetting unlicensed practice	No
Sexual Misconduct	No
Provider (e.g. Physician, Psychologist, Psychotherapist etc.) Impairment (e.g.drug, alcohol, mental physical)	No
Unprofessional Conduct (e.g. breach of confidence, record alteration, fraud, misleading advertising, arrest or conviction)	Yes
Office Practice (e.g. failure to provide patient/medical records to patient, failure to sign death certificate, patient abandonment):	Yes
Other:	No
If the complaint is medical/psychological/psychotherapy treatment related, please indicate the patient has been examined/treated by another provider/professional for this same condition?:	Yes
Have you initiated or filed legal action regarding this incident?	No
What is the desired outcome of your complaint submission?	Review license for gross negligence

Respondent

License Type:	Physician's and Surgeon's
First Name:	PAULA
Second Name:	LYNN
Last Name:	BAILEY-WALTON
Address:	25775 McBean Pkwy Ste 106
	VALENCIA, CA
	91355-3702
	US

Complainant

First Name:	Nicolas
Last Name:	Hernandez
Address:	[REDACTED]
	LOS ANGELES

████████ CA

9██████

US

Phone Number:

████████████████

E-mail Address:

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